

Boring

Putting the tools to work, Nimish went ahead and modified his new PC case.

Adding a transparent window by cutting out the sides of your case is perhaps one of the most common methods used by first time modders. "My case mod consists of a custom LED lighting with switching panel that switches between white and blue lighting. It also has two exhaust fans at the back and the top and two intake fans over the heatsink," claims Nimish.

He found the experience very enriching, and doing bits of designing and modding after a hectic work day and in between gym sessions didn't deter him. "This is what I like. The picture of a modded case with a window at the side is what got me going. I started making a design and also surfed the Net for a little bit of research," says Nimish. To top up the experience of doing something different, Nimish recorded every modding session on a forum, he also managed to take pictures using his mobile phone and post them on the forum.

One common problem faced by modders is that tinkering around with the case

Interesting Links

Here are a few links that Nimish suggests for fellow *Digit* readers interested in case modding:

How to mod a case

<http://snipurl.com/iqyz>

PC and Mod Tools

www.crazypc.com

www.pcsforeveryone.com

www.pctoys.com

www.xoxide.com

www.x-trememodz.com

www.case-mod.com

Cool Case Mods

Hypercube: <http://snipurl.com/iqz0>

Black Mesa Half Life 2:

<http://members.home.nl/gis/>

Doom3 Mars City

<http://snipurl.com/iqz1>

disrupts the airflow in the cabinet. This results in overheating and we all know what happens when our machines decide to toast! The art, according to Nimish, is to place your fans at strategic points, "I have an exhaust placed at the top of my cabinet. This has improved the heat dissipation from my system and it now runs at a range of 34-36 degree Celsius."

With all the designing and sweating, Nimish is now the proud owner and creator of his own customised PC cabinet. The most logical development from this would be to start off a case modding business. So does Nimish have any such ideas?

Well not as yet. "As of this case mod I think I'm done. My next mod will include a white cabinet and UV lighting options along with cable wraps."

Another project that I'm mulling over is a custom Linux box for routing and data centre purposes. This is where I could make some money. However, for implementing this, I would need substantial funds. Part of the plan is mount a 7-inch touch-screen for the monitor and interface it with the parallel port. The system will be administered remotely. So as of now, I'm currently working on the newer designs and also on ways to generate funds for the Linux project," says Nimish.

With ever-increasing awareness about computers and with people ready to explore their creativity beyond the normal canvas, case modding might move away from being just a hobby for a few geeks to a proper art form.

Moreover, as a cabinet occupies the prime place on your desk, it makes sense to have your signature on it. A PC is after all a 'Personal' Computer. ☐

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Photograph Jiten Gandhi

